

ParcelPilot Incident History and Postmortems

Resolved and inconclusive incidents with evidence, actions, and verification.

ParcelPilot operations reference

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1. INC-201: Orders database path lost after environment reset

Symptoms

All order-detail routes returned 500 while login worked.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

Repeated ORD-500 and a missing ORDERS_DB_PATH value.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Restored the path and restarted orders; verified multiple known-good orders.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

This incident is an example only. A new incident with similar symptoms still requires current evidence before the same cause is assigned.

Normal operating pattern

Normal order lookup reads the configured SQLite file, finds the requested order, and returns order details independently of tracking. ORD-404 for an unknown identifier is expected application behavior.

Failure pattern

ORD-500 DB_OPEN_FAILED points to the database path or file access. ORD-409 points to schema version mismatch. These failures can both become HTTP 500 responses at the API layer, but the corrective checks are different.

Worked example

If ORDERS_DB_PATH is missing and every tested order ID returns ORD-500, the missing database path is stronger evidence than a simultaneous tracking warning on another request.

Useful evidence to keep

- The exact incident time or best available time window.
- The route, service, and request_id when available.
- The specific error code rather than only the HTTP status.
- One known-good comparison case when practical.

The operator should also note what was checked and found to be normal. This prevents the next person from repeating the same work and helps keep an unrelated warning from becoming the assumed cause.

2. INC-202: Tracking provider timeout

Symptoms

Order details loaded but tracking requests timed out.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

TRK-504 burst and elevated tracking latency; orders remained normal.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Provider recovered; verified tracking on several orders.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

This incident is an example only. A new incident with similar symptoms still requires current evidence before the same cause is assigned.

Normal operating pattern

Normal tracking reads a recent carrier snapshot and returns a sequence of shipment events. Some orders legitimately have fewer events than others, so the number of events alone is not an error.

Failure pattern

TRK-206 means the response is incomplete, TRK-409 means the snapshot is too old, TRK-422 means the source cannot be used safely, and TRK-504 means the carrier lookup exceeded its timeout.

Worked example

A snapshot updated eight minutes ago with two events for one order may be valid partial data. A snapshot updated two hours ago should be treated as stale even if the JSON structure is valid.

Useful evidence to keep

- The exact incident time or best available time window.
- The route, service, and request_id when available.
- The specific error code rather than only the HTTP status.
- One known-good comparison case when practical.

The operator should also note what was checked and found to be normal. This prevents the next person from repeating the same work and helps keep an unrelated warning from becoming the assumed cause.

3. INC-203: Single account lock

Symptoms

One test user received 423 after repeated bad passwords.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

AUTH-423 for one account; auth service healthy.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Waited for lock expiry and corrected test credentials.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

This incident is an example only. A new incident with similar symptoms still requires current evidence before the same cause is assigned.

Timeline

The incident record should be read as a sequence rather than a final answer. Initial symptoms can be misleading, and later evidence may narrow the problem to a different dependency.

Previous incidents are useful for recognizing which checks have been productive in the past. They should not be used as a lookup table that automatically maps one symptom to one root cause.

Evidence quality

- Direct service error on the affected request is strong evidence.
- A matching configuration failure strengthens the service error.
- An unrelated warning at the same time is weak evidence.
- A similar incident months earlier is context, not proof.

When an old incident did not reach a clear cause, keep that uncertainty visible. Inconclusive history can be just as useful as a resolved postmortem because it shows where the available data stopped.

4. INC-204: Document permission change

Symptoms

Shipment PDFs failed while order details worked.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

DOC-403 on existing files.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Restored read permission and verified documents.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

This incident is an example only. A new incident with similar symptoms still requires current evidence before the same cause is assigned.

Normal operating pattern

Document routes first confirm the order and then look for the requested file under the configured store. Some orders do not have proof-of-delivery or customs documents, so a controlled not-found response can be normal.

Failure pattern

DOC-404, DOC-403, and DOC-500 should remain separate. A missing file, an unreadable file, and an invalid document root have different causes and different next checks.

Worked example

If label.pdf opens but proof.pdf returns DOC-404, do not change the global document-store path. Verify whether proof.pdf exists for that order.

Useful evidence to keep

- The exact incident time or best available time window.
- The route, service, and request_id when available.
- The specific error code rather than only the HTTP status.
- One known-good comparison case when practical.

The operator should also note what was checked and found to be normal. This prevents the next person from repeating the same work and helps keep an unrelated warning from becoming the assumed cause.

5. INC-205: Notification queue backlog

Symptoms

Notifications arrived 35-50 minutes late.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

NTF-429, queue depth above threshold, provider healthy.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Processed backlog and fixed duplicate test generation.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

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6. INC-206: Analytics report timeout

Symptoms

A 90-day report timed out while 7-day reports worked.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

RPT-504 on large range; service otherwise healthy.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Used narrower range and later optimized query.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

This incident is an example only. A new incident with similar symptoms still requires current evidence before the same cause is assigned.

Normal operating pattern

Reporting reads a separate analytics database. Small date ranges normally complete faster than large ones, and the same report can return different row counts as the requested window changes.

Failure pattern

RPT-422 is a validation problem, RPT-500 is a query failure, and RPT-504 is a timeout after execution begins. A timeout should be investigated with date range, query type, and repeated duration.

Worked example

A 90-day report timing out while 7-day reports complete in 300 ms is not the same as every report failing immediately with RPT-500.

Useful evidence to keep

- The exact incident time or best available time window.
- The route, service, and request_id when available.
- The specific error code rather than only the HTTP status.
- One known-good comparison case when practical.

The operator should also note what was checked and found to be normal. This prevents the next person from repeating the same work and helps keep an unrelated warning from becoming the assumed cause.

7. INC-207: Partial carrier snapshot

Symptoms

Some orders showed incomplete tracking history.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

TRK-206 and partial snapshot state.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Refreshed snapshot and kept partial flag visible.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

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8. INC-208: Stale carrier snapshot

Symptoms

Tracking events were several hours old.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

TRK-409 and old last_updated.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Restored refresh job and verified timestamp movement.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

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Timeline

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9. INC-209: Missed schema migration

Symptoms

Orders failed after application update.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

ORD-409 expected schema 8, found 7.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Ran training migration and restarted orders.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

This incident is an example only. A new incident with similar symptoms still requires current evidence before the same cause is assigned.

Timeline

The incident record should be read as a sequence rather than a final answer. Initial symptoms can be misleading, and later evidence may narrow the problem to a different dependency.

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10. INC-210: Auth service outage

Symptoms

Known-good users could not sign in.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

AUTH-503 across many accounts and auth status down.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Restarted auth and verified several accounts.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

This incident is an example only. A new incident with similar symptoms still requires current evidence before the same cause is assigned.

Normal operating pattern

Normal authentication traffic includes successful logins, occasional AUTH-401 responses for bad credentials, token refreshes, and a small number of expected account-lock events during testing.

Failure pattern

A service incident is more likely when known-good accounts fail together, AUTH-503 repeats across many request IDs, and the auth health state is degraded or down. A single AUTH-423 is an account-state problem until evidence shows broader impact.

Worked example

If one user is locked at 09:14 but two other known-good users sign in at 09:15, do not classify the event as an authentication outage.

Useful evidence to keep

- The exact incident time or best available time window.
- The route, service, and request_id when available.
- The specific error code rather than only the HTTP status.
- One known-good comparison case when practical.

The operator should also note what was checked and found to be normal. This prevents the next person from repeating the same work and helps keep an unrelated warning from becoming the assumed cause.

11. INC-211: Missing optional file mishandled

Symptoms

A missing proof-of-delivery file produced generic 500.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

DOC-404 was converted to API-500.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Corrected error mapping and verified controlled 404.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

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Timeline

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12. INC-212: Slow reports with no clear root cause

Symptoms

Users reported occasional slowness during local dataset import.

Scope

The team confirmed which user journeys still worked and whether the issue reproduced across several cases.

Evidence

No stable service error pattern; machine load elevated.

What was ruled out

Unrelated service warnings were reviewed but not used as the cause unless they matched the same request path and incident time.

Resolution

Recorded limitation; no product-service root cause assigned.

Verification

The original failing flow was tested again after the change and the result was recorded.

Use of this history

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Normal operating pattern

Reporting reads a separate analytics database. Small date ranges normally complete faster than large ones, and the same report can return different row counts as the requested window changes.

Failure pattern

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Worked example

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